LessonPlan Career Roadmap

Design and Architecture (Product, UX, Fashion, Architecture, Animation): Class 6 to Career

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This document sets out the pathway from Class 6 to career, covering entrance examinations, eligibility, scholarships, courses and career outcomes. Information is compiled from publicly available sources. Items marked **[VERIFY]** are subject to confirmation against the official notification of the conducting body before publication. See section 9 (Source and confidence log).

1. Pathway overview

Stage	When	Key decision	What it unlocks
Foundation	Class 6-8	Draw, build, observe; try art, craft, model-making, digital tools	Portfolio habit; interest signals
Pre-board	Class 9-10	Keep an art / sketch book; keep Maths if architecture or design technology interests you	Keeps NATA (Maths) and B.Des options open
Stream choice	After Class 10	Any stream for B.Des; Physics + Maths (+ Chemistry / Biology / CS) for B.Arch; Maths for B.FTech	UCEED, NID DAT, NIFT, NATA, JEE Main Paper 2A eligibility
Preparation	Class 11-12	Drawing practice, design aptitude, visual and logical reasoning; build a portfolio	Entrance tests (UCEED, NID DAT, NIFT, NATA, private tests)
Degree	After Class 12	B.Des (4 yr), B.Arch (5 yr), B.FTech (4 yr), private design degrees	Studio training, internships
Postgraduate	4-5 years later	M.Des (CEED), M.Arch, M.Plan, MBA in design management	Specialist and leadership roles
Career	-	Product, UX / UI, communication, fashion, interior, architecture, animation, games	See section 7

2. Stage-by-stage nodes

Class 6-10: Foundation

- Decision: draw, sketch, build models, photograph and observe. Try digital tools (drawing apps, simple 3D or coding).
- Start a portfolio: sketches, models, school projects and any art or craft. Portfolios matter for some institutes and interviews. **[VERIFY which institutes require portfolios]**
- Keep Standard Maths in Class 10 (CBSE) if architecture or B.FTech is a possibility. **[VERIFY current CBSE rule]**

After Class 10: Stream choice

- B.Des (UCEED, NID DAT, NIFT): any stream in Class 12 is eligible.
- B.Arch (NATA or JEE Main Paper 2A): Class 12 with Physics and Maths plus one more listed subject (Chemistry, Biology, Computer Science and others) with about 45% aggregate. Most colleges expect PCM. **[VERIFY]**
- B.FTech (NIFT): Maths needed in Class 12.
- Karnataka note: Class 11-12 is the 2-year Pre-University Course (PUC) after SSLC; CBSE/ICSE schools run Class 11-12 directly.

Class 11-12: Preparation

- Practise freehand drawing, composition, observation, visual reasoning and basic maths / logic. Prepare for the day-of-test pen-and-paper drawing.

- Many tests are held between October and June; register early because NID, UCEED and NIFT windows can close in the autumn and winter.

After Class 12: Degree

- B.Des at IITs, NID, NIFT, private universities; B.Arch at architecture colleges approved by the Council of Architecture; fashion, animation, game design and interior design at specialised institutes.

After the degree: Career

- Studio work, agencies, in-house design teams, start-ups, architecture practice (CoA registration), research, teaching and higher study.

3. Early preparation (Class 6-12)

Exam / route	Conducted by	Classes	Details	Timing
Art and design competitions, olympiads and workshops	Schools, NGOs, art institutes	6-12	Builds drawing and creativity; no formal entrance value	Through the year
NTSE	NCERT; Karnataka Stage 1 via DSERT	10	Not design-specific; covers Social Science and Mental Ability	2026-27 notification expected Aug-Oct **[VERIFY]**
NMMS (scholarship test)	Karnataka DSERT / KSEAB	8	Single written test	Apply Sep-Oct; exam Jan-Feb

Tip for parents: design colleges look for curiosity and process, not only drawing skill. Keep a dated sketch book and photograph projects as a portfolio.

4. Entrance exams

UCEED (Undergraduate Common Entrance Exam for Design) - IIT Bombay	
Conducting body	IIT Bombay; uceed.iitb.ac.in
Used for	B.Des at IIT Bombay, IIT Delhi, IIT Guwahati, IIT Hyderabad, IIT Roorkee, IIT Indore and IIITDM Jabalpur; many other institutes accept scores **[VERIFY participating list]**
Eligibility	Any stream. Class 12 (or equivalent) appeared for the first time in 2026 or 2027. Born on or after 1 Oct 2002 (1 Oct 1997 for SC/ST/PwD) **[VERIFY]**
Frequency / dates	Once a year; UCEED 2027 reported for 17 January 2027; registration reported 1-31 October 2026 (one source gives 21 October) **[VERIFY]**
Pattern (previous year pattern)	Part A: computer-based, 2 hours, 200 marks (numerical answers, multiple select and multiple choice; partial negative marking for MCQ / MSQ; no negative marking for numerical). Part B: pen-and-paper drawing, 1 hour, 100 marks, checked only if Part A cutoff is cleared. Total 300 **[VERIFY 2027 brochure]**

NID DAT (Design Aptitude Test) - National Institute of Design	
Conducting body	National Institute of Design (NID); admissions.nid.edu
Used for	B.Des at NID campuses (including Bengaluru) **[VERIFY seats]**
Eligibility	10+2 in any stream; Maths recommended; no upper age limit; General and EWS candidates born on or after 1 July 2006 (one source) **[VERIFY]**
Frequency / dates	Once a year; applications reported 10 Sep - 30 Nov 2026; DAT Prelims 20 December 2026; final Class 12 marksheet by 15 July 2027 **[VERIFY]**
Pattern	Prelims, then Mains with studio tests and interview. Prelims structure not confirmed at the time of compilation **[VERIFY]**

NIFT (National Institute of Fashion Technology)	
Conducting body	NIFT with NTA; nift.ac.in

Eligibility	B.Des: Class 12 in any stream. B.FTech: Mathematics required (Physics and Maths per one source). UG age: under 24 on 1 Aug 2027 (5-year relaxation SC/ST/PwD) **[VERIFY]**
Pattern	GAT (General Ability Test) and CAT (Creative Ability Test), then Situation Test / interview for some courses **[VERIFY]**
Frequency / dates	Once a year; 2027 dates not yet published **[VERIFY]**

NATA (National Aptitude Test in Architecture)	
Conducting body	Council of Architecture (CoA); nata.in
Used for	B.Arch admissions (JEE Main Paper 2A is the alternative)
Eligibility	Passed or appearing in Class 12 with Physics and Maths, or a 10+3 diploma with Maths; about 45% aggregate (one source says 50%); college rules often higher **[VERIFY]**
Frequency / dates	Multiple sessions in one academic year, best score counts. 2026 window 4 April - 13 June (Fri / Sat); attempts reported as two or three **[VERIFY on nata.in]**
Pattern	3 hours, 200 marks: Part A drawing and composition (80, offline) and Part B aptitude (120, online); no negative marking reported **[VERIFY]**

JEE Main Paper 2A (B.Arch) and 2B (B.Planning)	
Conducting body	NTA; jeemain.nta.nic.in
Pattern	400 marks each (reported); see Science PCM document for JEE Main details **[VERIFY]**
Used for	B.Arch / B.Planning at NITs and other participating institutes via JoSAA **[VERIFY]**

Other routes

Route	For	Key details
KCET (with NATA) for B.Arch in Karnataka	B.Arch seats in Karnataka colleges	Combines NATA and board / KCET marks per KEA rules **[VERIFY]**
Private design institutes (Srishti, MIT Institute of Design, Pearl Academy, Symbiosis SID, Anant, others)	B.Des, fashion, animation, interior	Own entrance tests and portfolio rounds; dates and fees vary **[VERIFY]**
CUET-UG	BA / BFA at central universities	50 MCQs per subject, 60 min, +5 / -1; see Science documents **[VERIFY]**
Animation, game design, interior design, UX diplomas	Short and long courses after Class 12	Industry-linked institutes; quality varies, check recognition **[VERIFY]**

Postgraduate and beyond (preview)

Exam	Body	For	Tentative timing
CEED (Common Entrance Exam for Design)	IIT Bombay	M.Des and PhD at IITs and others	January (with UCEED) **[VERIFY]**
GATE (Architecture and Planning)	IIT-organised	M.Arch, M.Plan	Feb **[VERIFY]**
NID M.Des / NIFT M.Des / MFM	NID / NIFT	Postgraduate design and fashion	Yearly **[VERIFY]**
CoA registration	Council of Architecture	Practise as an architect after B.Arch	After degree **[VERIFY]**

5. Scholarships and financial support

Scholarship	Provider	Who can apply	Amount	Window
Institute scholarships (IITs, NID, NIFT, private universities)	Institutes and foundations	Merit and need based	Varies	Check each institute **[VERIFY]**
NMMS	Govt. of India via Karnataka DSERT	Class 8 in govt/aided/local body schools; family income up to 3.5 lakh; at least 55% in Class 7 (50% SC/ST) **[VERIFY: single source]**	12,000 per year (1,000 per month), Class 9-12	Apply Sep-Oct; exam Jan-Feb
CSSS (Central Sector Scheme)	Ministry of Education via National Scholarship Portal	Top 20% of successful candidates in own board and stream; family income up to 4.5 lakh	12,000 per year for UG years 1-3; 20,000 per year for years 4-5 / PG	2026-27 portal opened 1 Jun 2026; one listing shows 31 Oct 2026 deadline **[VERIFY]**
Post-matric scholarships	National Scholarship Portal and Karnataka SSP	SC/ST/OBC/minority categories, income limits	Varies	Typically Jul-Nov **[VERIFY]**

Note: INSPIRE-SHE is for natural and basic sciences and does not apply to design students. **[VERIFY]**

6. Courses, training and institutions

Course / programme	Duration	Entry	Note
B.Des (Product, Communication, Interaction, Textile, Fashion, Animation, Interior)	4 yr	UCEED, NID DAT, NIFT, private tests	Studio-based degree
B.Arch	5 yr	NATA or JEE Main Paper 2A	CoA-approved; registration to practise
B.FTech	4 yr	NIFT with Maths	Fashion technology
B.Planning	4 yr	JEE Main Paper 2B and others	Urban and regional planning
BFA / BA Design / Animation	3-4 yr	College tests, CUET	Fine arts, visual communication
M.Des / M.Arch / M.Plan	2 yr	CEED, GATE, college tests	Specialisation and research

Examples of institutions (illustrative, not a ranking): IIT Bombay (IDC), IIT Delhi, IIT Guwahati, IIT Hyderabad, NID (including Bengaluru), NIFT (including Bengaluru), Srishti Manipal Institute, MIT Institute of Design, RV College of Architecture, BMS School of Architecture, CEPT University. **[VERIFY availability, fees and admission route]**

7. Career outcomes

Path	Job roles	Higher study / growth
Product and industrial design	Product designer, design engineer, CMF designer, design researcher	M.Des, design management
UX / UI and interaction	UX designer, UI designer, service designer, UX researcher	M.Des in interaction, HCI
Communication and graphic design	Graphic designer, brand designer, art director, illustrator	M.Des, creative leadership
Fashion and textile	Fashion designer, merchandiser, stylist, textile designer	M.Des, MFM, retail management
Architecture and planning	Architect, urban planner, landscape and interior architect	M.Arch, M.Plan, CoA registration
Animation, games and media	Animator, VFX artist, game designer, motion designer	Specialised courses

8. Related umbrellas this one connects to

- Science PCM: B.Arch and B.FTech need Physics and Maths (see Science PCM document).
- Arts and Humanities: B.Des and BFA are open to all streams (see Arts and Humanities document).
- Commerce: brand, marketing and retail design combine with management (see Commerce document).
- Technology: UX, game design and design engineering sit between design and computer science.
- Entrepreneurship and skills: freelance design and studios (see Skills and Entrepreneurship document).

9. Source and confidence log

Confidence reflects the type of source available. Items rely on publicly available secondary sources unless stated otherwise.

Item	Finding	Confidence
UCEED 2027	IIT Bombay; 17 Jan 2027; registration 1-31 Oct 2026 (one source 21 Oct); any stream; Part A 200 + Part B 100 (previous pattern); participating IITs listed as six IITs plus IIITDM Jabalpur	Medium
NID DAT 2027	Applications 10 Sep - 30 Nov 2026; Prelims 20 Dec 2026; birth-date cutoff 1 Jul 2006; prelims structure not found	Low-Medium
NIFT 2027	B.Des any stream; B.FTech needs Maths; under 24 on 1 Aug 2027; dates not published	Medium / Low
NATA	200 marks (80 + 120), 3 hr; 45% (one source 50%); attempts two or three; 2026 window 4 Apr - 13 Jun	Medium / Low
Private design institutes	Not researched in detail	Low

Still to verify on official sites

- Official UCEED 2027 brochure (dates, pattern, institutes); NID DAT 2027 prelims structure; NIFT 2027 notification; NATA 2027 schedule and attempt rules.
- Karnataka B.Arch admission route (KCET + NATA); private institutes' tests, fees and recognition.
- Official sources: uceed.iitb.ac.in, admissions.nid.edu, nift.ac.in, nata.in, coa.gov.in, jeemain.nta.nic.in, kea.kar.nic.in.
- Dates shift every year. Replace "tentative month" with the official notification date before publishing.

ONE-PAGE GIST: Design and Architecture

Items marked **[VERIFY]** are subject to confirmation against official notifications (see the detailed document).

Stage	What to do
Class 6-10	Sketch book, models, digital tools; keep Standard Maths if architecture is possible
After Class 10	Any stream for B.Des; PCM-based for B.Arch / B.FTech; PUC in Karnataka
Class 11-12	Boards + drawing and aptitude practice; UCEED, NID DAT, NIFT, NATA
After Class 12	B.Des (4 yr), B.Arch (5 yr), B.FTech, BFA, animation and interior courses
Postgraduate	M.Des (CEED), M.Arch, M.Plan, design management
Career	Product, UX, communication, fashion, architect, animation, interiors

Exam / route	When	Pattern / key point	Marking
UCEED	January (2027: 17 Jan)	Part A 200 + Part B drawing 100; any stream	Check brochure
NID DAT	Prelims 20 Dec 2026 **[VERIFY]**	Prelims then Mains / studio; any stream	Check brochure
NIFT	Yearly **[VERIFY]**	GAT + CAT (+ situation test); B.FTech needs Maths	Check notification
NATA	Apr-Jun sessions	3 hr, 200 marks: drawing 80 + aptitude 120	No negative reported
JEE Main Paper 2A	Jan and Apr	B.Arch via NITs; 400 marks	Check bulletin

Key rules: B.Des accepts all streams; B.Arch needs Physics + Maths (about 45%); build a portfolio from Class 8. **[VERIFY]**

Scholarships: NMMS (Class 8), CSSS (UG), institute scholarships. **[VERIFY]**

Careers: designer (product, UX, graphic, fashion), architect, planner, animator, interior designer.

Want a personalised roadmap or counselling? Contact LessonPlan, Yelahanka, Bangalore.